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CORE JOINING FOR EMBEDDED DIE WITHIN PACKAGE SUBSTRATES

Abstract

IC device package including an IC die embedded within a package substrate comprising two or more substrate cores. A cutout in a first substrate core exposes a surface of a second substrate core and an IC die is placed within the opening. A package metallization routing structure including conductive vias adjacent to the embedded IC die may be built up and terminate interconnect interfaces. One or more additional IC dies may be assembled with the package substrate, coupling the additional IC dies with the embedded IC die. In some examples, the embedded IC die comprises capacitors implementing a package-level voltage regulator.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

[0001] In electronics manufacturing, IC packaging is a stage of semiconductor device fabrication in which an IC that has been fabricated on a chip (or die) comprising a semiconducting material is assembled into a “package” that can protect the IC chip from physical damage and support electrical interconnects that couple the IC to a scaled host component, such as a package substrate, or a printed circuit board. Multiple chips can be co-assembled, for example, into a multi-chip package (MCP).

[0002] Advanced IC die packages may place additional demands on power delivery architectures. A power delivery architecture may include one or more voltage regulators (VRs) to scale voltages down from a system level (e.g., 12V) to a packaged IC die level (e.g., ~0.5-1.5V). It is advantageous for such voltage reduction to occur as near to an IC die as possible, for example to reduce losses associated with elevated current levels needed at lower voltages. Accordingly, it may be advantageous to integrate one or more VRs within a package, particularly a multi-chip package where power demands become compounded. An IC die including passive and/or active devices supporting the integration of a VR into the package may, for example, be embedded within the package.

[0003] Advanced IC die packages may also place additional demands on electrical interconnects. Package electrical interconnection between multiple IC dies is important to ensure highest device performance as die-to-die bandwidth is often significantly higher than die-to-host bandwidth. An IC die may, for example, be embedded within a package to provide die-to-die interconnection at higher densities than the package routing that surrounds the embedded interconnect die.

[0004] These examples of advanced packaging rely on successfully embedding an IC die, which can be challenging, in part, because of height mismatch between the IC die to be embedded and the package structure within which the IC die is to be embedded. Some height mismatch may be attributable to package preforms, such as substrate cores, that have some total thickness variation (TTV). Some height mismatch may also be attributable to variation in a height or depth of a recess or cavity formed within a package preform to accommodate an embedded IC die.

[0005] Accordingly, alternative packaging architectures comprising an embedded IC die may be commercially advantageous.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0006] The material described herein is illustrated by way of example and not by way of limitation in the accompanying figures. For simplicity and clarity of illustration, elements illustrated in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions of some elements may be exaggerated relative to other elements for clarity. Further, where considered appropriate, reference labels have been repeated among the figures to indicate corresponding or analogous elements. In the figures:

[0007] FIG. 1 illustrates a flow diagram of methods for forming an IC die package including an IC

die embedded within a substrate core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0008] FIG. 2A illustrates a plan view of a workpiece comprising a first substrate core, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0009] FIG. 2B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 2A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0010] FIG. 3A illustrates a plan view of cutouts formed in the first substrate core, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0011] FIG. 3B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 3A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0012] FIG. 4A illustrates a plan view of a workpiece comprising a second substrate core, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0013] FIG. 4B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 4A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0014] FIG. 5A illustrates a plan view of a first substrate core fused with a second substrate core into a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0015] FIG. 5B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 5A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0016] FIG. 6A illustrates a plan view of embedding IC die within a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0017] FIG. 6B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 6A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0018] FIG. 7 illustrates an expanded cross-sectional view of the IC die illustrated in FIG. 6A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0019] FIG. 8A illustrates a plan view of planarizing a workpiece comprising an IC die embedded within a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0020] FIG. 8B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 8A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0021] FIG. 9 illustrates a flow diagram of methods for forming an IC die package including an IC die embedded within a stacked core, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0022] FIG. 10A illustrates a plan view depicting the formation of through vias in a workpiece comprising a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0023] FIG. 10B illustrates a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 10A, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0024] FIG. 11A is a plan view illustrating a build-up of package metallization levels on at least one side of a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0025] FIG. 11B is a cross-sectional view of the workpiece illustrated in FIG. 11A, in accordance with some embodiments including package metallization levels built-up on two opposite sides of a core stack;

[0026] FIG. 12 illustrates a cross-sectional view illustrating one package substrate including an IC die embedded within a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0027] FIG. 13 illustrates a cross-sectional view of multiple IC die coupled to the package substrate illustrated in FIG. 12, in accordance with some embodiments;

[0028] FIG. 14 illustrates a mobile computing platform or a data server machine employing a package comprising an IC die embedded within a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments; and

[0029] FIG. 15 is a functional block diagram of an electronic computing device, in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

[0030] Embodiments are described with reference to the enclosed figures. While specific configurations and arrangements are depicted and discussed in detail, this is done for illustrative

purposes only. Persons skilled in the relevant art will recognize that other configurations and arrangements are possible without departing from the spirit and scope of the description. It will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art that techniques and/or arrangements described herein may be employed in a variety of other systems and applications other than what is described in detail herein.

[0031] Reference is made in the following detailed description to the accompanying drawings, which form a part hereof and illustrate exemplary embodiments. Further, it is to be understood that other embodiments may be utilized and structural and/or logical changes may be made without departing from the scope of claimed subject matter. It should also be noted that directions and references, for example, up, down, top, bottom, and so on, may be used merely to facilitate the description of features in the drawings. Therefore, the following detailed description is not to be taken in a limiting sense and the scope of claimed subject matter is defined solely by the appended claims and their equivalents.

[0032] In the following description, numerous details are set forth. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art, that embodiments may be practiced without these specific details. In some instances, well-known methods and devices are shown in block diagram form, rather than in detail, to avoid obscuring the embodiments. Reference throughout this specification to “an embodiment” or “one embodiment” or “some embodiments” means that a particular feature, structure, function, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment is included in at least one embodiment. Thus, the appearances of the phrase “in an embodiment” or “in one embodiment” or “some embodiments” in various places throughout this specification are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Furthermore, the particular features, structures, functions, or characteristics may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. For example, a first embodiment may be combined with a second embodiment anywhere the particular features, structures, functions, or characteristics associated with the two embodiments are not mutually exclusive.

[0033] As used in the description and the appended claims, the singular forms “a”, “an” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will also be understood that the term “and/or” as used herein refers to and encompasses any and all possible combinations of one or more of the associated listed items.

[0034] The terms “coupled” and “connected,” along with their derivatives, may be used herein to describe functional or structural relationships between components. These terms are not intended as synonyms for each other. Rather, in particular embodiments, “connected” may be used to indicate that two or more elements are in direct physical, optical, or electrical contact with each other. “Coupled” may be used to indicate that two or more elements are in either direct or indirect (with other intervening elements between them) physical or electrical contact with each other, and/or that the two or more elements co-operate or interact with each other (e.g., as in a cause-and-effect relationship).

[0035] The terms “over,” “under,” “between,” and “on” as used herein refer to a relative position of one component or material with respect to other components or materials where such physical relationships are noteworthy. For example, in the context of materials, one material or layer over or under another may be directly in contact or may have one or more intervening materials or layers. Moreover, one material between two materials or layers may be directly in contact with the two materials/layers or may have one or more intervening materials/layers. In contrast, a first material or layer “on” a second material or layer is in direct contact with that second material/layer. Similar distinctions are to be made in the context of component assemblies.

[0036] As used throughout this description, and in the claims, a list of items joined by the term “at least one of” or “one or more of” can mean any combination of the listed terms. For example, the phrase “at least one of A, B or C” can mean A; B; C; A and B; A and C; B and C; or A, B and C.

[0037] Unless otherwise specified in the specific context of use, the term “predominantly” means

more than 50%, or more than half. For example, a composition that is predominantly a first constituent means more than half of the composition is the first constituent (e.g., <50 at. %). The term “primarily” means the most, or greatest, part. For example, a composition that is primarily a first constituent means the composition has more of the first constituent than any other constituent. A composition that is primarily first and second constituents means the composition has more of the first and second constituents than any other constituent. The term “substantially” means there is only incidental variation. For example, composition that is substantially a first constituent means the composition may further include <1% of any other constituent. A composition that is substantially first and second constituents means the composition may further include <1% of any constituent substituted for either the first or second constituent.

[0038] IC package structures including an IC die embedded within a package substrate core stack are described herein. Two or more substrate cores may be fused or bonded together into the core stack. A first core is advantageously of a thickness substantially equal to the thickness of an IC die that is to be embedded within the core stack, or is otherwise a good thickness match with the IC die thickness. A cutout (or large through hole) sufficiently large to accommodate the IC die may be formed into the first substrate core. The first substrate core may be fused or bonded with a second substrate core of any desired thickness and IC die positioned within the cutout in the first substrate core. Package dielectric and metallization features (e.g., comprising a redistribution layer (RDL)) may be formed on one or more sides of the core stack. Accordingly, packaging dielectric(s) may be applied adjacent to, and over, the embedded die. After building up the package, additional IC die may be attached, and the package assembled to a host component.

[0039] A variety of fabrication methods may be practiced to fabricate multi-chip device structures having one or more of the features or attributes described herein. FIG. 1 illustrates a flow diagram of methods **101** for forming an IC die package including an IC die embedded within a substrate core stack, in accordance with some exemplary embodiments.

[0040] Methods **101** begin at input **110** with the receipt of a first substrate core preform that has been fabricated upstream of methods **101**. In methods **101**, the first substrate core preform is to be fused, bonded, or otherwise joined into a stack with at least one other core preform. The first substrate core preform is advantageously thickness matched to one or more IC dies that are to be embedded with a package substrate that includes the first substrate core. As used herein, “thickness matched” means the first substrate core has a thickness (e.g., by cutting, grinding and/or polishing) predetermined to ensure a surface of an IC die having another predetermined thickness is at a desired height relative to a surface of the package substrate. As described further below, an IC die of a predetermined thickness may have a surface that is substantially coplanar with a surface of the first substrate core when the IC die is positioned within a package substrate comprising the first substrate core.

[0041] FIG. 2A illustrates a plan view of a workpiece **200** comprising a first substrate core **201**, in accordance with some embodiments. Workpiece **200** may have a working surface (e.g., within the x-y plane) of any area suitable for high volume manufacturing. In some embodiments, workpiece **200** is approximately the size of a typical silicon wafer (e.g., 300-450 mm diameter). In other embodiments, workpiece **200** is a rectilinear panel having any x-axis and y-axis dimensions suitable for large format panel processing.

[0042] As shown, FIG. 2B illustrates a cross-sectional view of workpiece **200** along the B-B' line shown in FIG. 2A, in accordance with some embodiments. In the example shown, workpiece **200** is apportionable into a plurality of package substrate regions, portions, or areas **201A**, **201B**, and **201C**. As described further below, each of substrate regions **201A-201C** may have a length (e.g., in at least the x-dimension) of 200 μm to 100 mm, or more. Substrate core **201** has a total core thickness T1 between opposite sides. Core thickness T1 may be between 50 μm and 1.4 mm, for example. In some embodiments, core thickness T1 is more specifically between 100 μm and 800 μm .

[0043] In some embodiments, substrate core **201** is a bulk material. Chemical composition of the

bulk material may vary. Substrate core **201** may be substantially pure silicon, or a ceramic, for example. In some advantageous embodiments however, substrate core **201** is a single piece of bulk glass. Glass may be advantageously processed to a flatness comparable to that of a silicon wafer. For example, surface **208** advantageously has an RMS roughness of no more than 50 nm.

[0044] Substrate core **201** may be predominantly silica (e.g., silicon and oxygen) and may further include one or more compositional additives, such as, aluminum, beryllium, magnesium, calcium, strontium barium, radium, tin, sodium, silver potassium, boron, phosphorus, zirconium, lithium, titanium, or zinc. Substrate core **201** may therefore be any of aluminosilicate, borosilicate, alumino-borosilicate, or silica etc. Substrate core **201** may be primarily silicon, oxygen, and aluminum, for example. In some advantageous embodiments, substrate core **201** is glass comprising at least 23 weight percent silicon and at least 26 weight percent oxygen, and further comprising at least 5 weight percent aluminum.

[0045] Chemical composition of substrate core **201** may be substantially homogeneous, or not. Core **201** may have nanosized aggregates of a different composition than a remainder of the bulk, for example. Core **201** may also have a varying compositional profile across core thickness T1. FIG. 2B, for example, illustrates two surface thicknesses or zones **202** and **203**. Either (or both) of surface zones **202**, **203** may have a different chemical composition than a remainder (e.g., center thickness or zone **204**) of substrate core **201**. Surface zones **202**, **203** may each have a thickness corresponding to up 20% of core thickness T1, for example. As illustrated in the dopant profile of FIG. 2B, surface zone **202** and/or surface zone **203** has a higher concentration of one or more dopants D than the center zone **204** proximal to the half substrate thickness ($T1/2$). Dopants D may be in the form of atomic ions or molecular ions (i.e., ion-exchange doping). Dopants D may, for example, increase the hardness of surface zones **202** and/or **203**. Although the surface zone dopants may be any of those described above, in some exemplary embodiments surface zone **202** and/or **203** has more of K, Na, or Ag than center zone **204**.

[0046] In exemplary embodiments, substrate core **201** is substantially amorphous, but may alternatively have an ordered nanostructure or microstructure. Substrate core **201** may be quartz glass, for example, having nanocrystalline, polycrystalline, or even substantially monocrystalline microstructure. Aggregates corresponding to compositional inhomogeneity may also have different microstructure than a remainder of substrate core **201**.

[0047] Substrate core **201** may include one or more thin film material layers on one or both of a front side or back side of the bulk material. For example, in embodiments where substrate core **201** is other than glass (e.g., silicon or a ceramic), a thin film of silicon dioxide or silicon nitride may be on either a front or back surface of substrate core **201** (e.g., corresponding to surface zone **202** and/or surface zone **203**).

[0048] Returning to FIG. 1, methods **101** continue at block **120** where openings, cutouts or holes are formed through the total thickness of the first core substrate. Although illustrated as part of methods **101**, block **120** may alternatively be performed upstream of methods **101** such that the first core substrate is a preform both with a predetermined target thickness and having one or more cutouts. Cutouts may be formed according to any technique(s) known to be suitable for the chemical composition of the first core substrate. For example, one or more of laser ablation, mechanical drilling, and/or chemical etching may be practiced at block **120**.

[0049] At least one cutout formed at block **120** has dimensions sufficient to accommodate one or more IC die within the cutout. One or more such cutouts may be formed at block **120**. Additional through holes, for example having smaller dimensions suitable for conductive through vias may also be formed at block **120**. If formed, smaller dimensioned through holes may be filled with conductive material (e.g., with a copper plating process) such that the core preform further includes through-core electrically conductive routes.

[0050] FIG. 3A illustrates a plan view of workpiece **200**, which further includes cutouts or openings **310** passing through substrate core **201**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 3B

illustrates a cross-sectional view of workpiece **200** along the B-B' line illustrated in FIG. 3A, in accordance with some embodiments. In the illustrated example, one opening **310** is within each of package substrate areas **201A**, **201B** and **201C**. However, more than one opening **310** may be formed within an area that corresponds with a single package substrate. Opening **310** has a length L (e.g., y-dimension) and a width W (e.g., x-dimension) at least exceeding an edge length of an IC die that is to be embedded within a package substrate. In some embodiments, length L is within a range of 200 μm to 20 mm and width W is also with a range of 200 μm to 20 mm. As shown in FIG. 3B, Each opening **310** extends through an entirety of total core thickness T1.

[0051] Returning to FIG. 1, methods **101** continue with the receipt of a second substrate core at input **115**. At block **130** the substrate core received at input **110** is joined with the substrate core received at input **115** into a substrate core stack. FIG. 4A illustrates a plan view of a workpiece **400** comprising a second substrate core **401**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 4B illustrates a cross-sectional view of workpiece **400** along the B-B' line shown in FIG. 4A, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0052] Workpiece **400** may have a working surface (e.g., within the x-y plane) of any area suitable for high volume manufacturing. In some embodiments, workpiece **400** is approximately the size of a typical silicon wafer (e.g., 300-450 mm diameter). In other embodiments, workpiece **400** is a rectilinear panel having any x-axis and y-axis dimensions suitable for large format panel processing. Workpiece **400** may be approximately the same dimensions as workpiece **200** (FIG. 2A), for example. As shown in FIG. 4B, substrate core **401** has a total core thickness T2 between opposite sides. Core thickness T2 may be any thickness, for example to ensure adequate mechanical support of a core stack further including substrate core **201** (FIG. 2B). In exemplary embodiments, core thickness T2 (FIG. 4B) is between 50 μm and 3 mm. In some embodiments, core thickness T2 is greater than core thickness T1 (FIG. 2B).

[0053] Substrate core **401** may also be a bulk material, the chemical composition of which may vary. In advantageous embodiments, substrate core **401** has substantially the same composition as substrate core **201** (FIG. 2A), which ensures good match of material properties between substrate cores **201** and **401**. Accordingly, substrate core **401** may also be substantially pure silicon, or a ceramic, for example. However, in some advantageous embodiments, substrate core **401** is a single piece of bulk glass. Glass may be advantageously processed to have a surface flatness comparable to that of a silicon wafer. For example, core surface **408** advantageously has an RMS roughness of no more than 50 nm.

[0054] In some embodiments, substrate core **401** is predominantly silica (e.g., silicon and oxygen) and may further include one or more compositional additives, such as aluminum, beryllium, magnesium, calcium, strontium barium, radium, tin, sodium, silver potassium, boron, phosphorus, zirconium, lithium, titanium, or zinc. Substrate core **401** may therefore be any of aluminosilicate, borosilicate, alumino-borosilicate, or silica, etc. Substrate core **401** may be primarily silicon, oxygen, and aluminum, for example. In some advantageous embodiments, substrate core **401** is glass comprising at least 23 weight percent silicon and at least 26 weight percent oxygen, and further comprising at least 5 weight percent aluminum.

[0055] Chemical composition of substrate core **401** may be substantially homogeneous, or not. Substrate core **401** may have nanosized aggregates of a different composition than a remainder of the bulk, for example. Substrate core **401** may also have a varying compositional profile across core thickness T2. FIG. 2B, for example, illustrates a dopant profile for substrate core embodiments including two surface thicknesses or zones **402** and **403**. Either (or both) of surface zones **402**, **403** may have a different chemical composition than a remainder (e.g., center thickness or zone **404**) of substrate core **401**. Surface zones **402**, **403** may each have a thickness corresponding to 5-20% of core thickness T2, for example. In some embodiments, surface zone **402** and/or surface zone **403** has a higher concentration of one or more dopants D than center zone **404**. Such dopants may, for example, increase the hardness of surface zones **402** and/or **403**. Although the surface zone dopants

may be any of those described above, in some exemplary embodiments surface zone **402** and/or **403** has more of K, Na, or Ag than center zone **404** proximal to the half core thickness ($T2/2$). In some embodiments, the composition of surface zones **402** and **403** is substantially the same as that of surface zone **202** and **203** in substrate core **201** (FIG. 2B).

[0056] Substrate core **401** may be substantially amorphous, or alternatively have an ordered nanostructure or microstructure. Substrate core **401** may be quartz glass, for example, having nanocrystalline, polycrystalline, or even substantially monocrystalline microstructure. Aggregates corresponding to compositional inhomogeneity may also have different microstructure than a remainder of substrate core **401**.

[0057] Substrate core **401** may include one or more thin film material layers on one or both of a front side or back side of the bulk material. For example, in embodiments where substrate core **401** is other than glass (e.g., silicon or a ceramic), a thin film of silicon dioxide or silicon nitride may be on either a front or back surface of substrate core **401** (e.g., corresponding to surface zone **402** and/or surface zone **403**). According to some embodiments, substrate core **401** is nearly identical to substrate core **201** with a primary difference being their respective thicknesses, $T1$ and $T2$.

[0058] Although not illustrated in FIG. 4A or FIG. 4B, substrate core **401** may be similarly processed to include conductive through vias according to any known techniques. For example, one or more of mechanical drilling, laser ablation or etching may be practiced to form through vias into which a metal (e.g., copper) or other conductive material is deposited.

[0059] Methods **101** (FIG. 1) illustrate a joining of two substrate cores into a core stack. However, three or more such cores may be similarly joined. The core joining at block **130** may with any means suitable for the cores. In some a embodiments, the cores are directly bonded together. For exemplary embodiments where two substrate cores are bulk glass, the cores may be directly fused into a single piece of glass. Depending on the features present within each of the core preforms joined, block **130** may comprise aligning features of one substrate core to features of another substrate core.

[0060] For embodiments where both substrate core **401** and substrate core **201** include conductive vias one or more of the conductive vias in one core may be aligned to intersect one or more of the conductive vias in another core such that, upon joining, a conductive route extends through a total thickness of the two substrate cores. If such conductive vias are present, bonding performed at block **130** may be referred to as hybrid bonding where a bond interface passes through both silica and metallization. Although there are many bonding process, in exemplary embodiments block **130** comprises the application of at least one of heat and pressure across an interface between two core surfaces to be joined.

[0061] In some alternative embodiments, solder features may join substrate cores **201** and **401**. Such solder features may be solder balls, bumps or posts, etc., which have been applied to metallization features on a joining surface of substrate core **201** or substrate core **401**. The metallization features on joining substrate surfaces that are solder bonded, may be interfaces of conductive through vias, for example. The metallization features on joining substrate surfaces that are solder bonded may also be surface pads, for example fabricated with an semi-additive substrate metallization process. For solder bonded embodiments, a dielectric underfill material may be present around the solder features, or not.

[0062] FIG. 5A illustrates a plan view of a stacked workpiece **500** comprising substrate core **201** joined to substrate core **401**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 5B illustrates a cross-sectional view of workpiece **500** further illustrating a core stack **501** along the B-B' line shown in FIG. 5A. Within openings **310**, core surface **408** is exposed. Upon the joining of substrate cores **201** and **401**, openings **310** become recesses or cavities rather than through holes. However, because openings **310** were cutouts or through holes of a preform and core surface **408** is unaffected by the core joining, core surface **408** may advantageously retain very high surface quality (e.g., RMS roughness <50 nm). Furthermore, the depth of openings **310** is very well

controlled to be precisely equal to core thickness T1 of substrate core **201**.

[0063] As further illustrated in FIG. **5B**, a core interface **510** is coincident, or co-planar with, core surface **408** unless cores **201** and **401** are joined by intervening solder features **511** (illustrated in dashed line as applicable to only some embodiments). For substrate cores in direct contact, core interface **510** may be visible (e.g., through SEM imaging) depending on the compositions of substrate cores **201**, **401**. Interface **510** may also be evident through material analysis techniques (e.g., SIMS or EELs, etc.) suitable for determining a chemical composition profile through the core stack **501**. For embodiments where at least one of substrate core **201** or **401** has a surface zone with higher dopant concentration [D], core stack **501** will have a center zone of higher dopant concentration [D] corresponding to the surface zone (e.g., **203** or **402**). For embodiments where substrate core **401** has surface zone **402**, surface zone **402** will also be present at a bottom of openings **310**. For embodiments where substrate core **201** has surface zone **203**, but substrate core **401** lacks surface zone **402**, surface zone **402** will be absent from the bottom of openings **310**.

[0064] For embodiments where both substrate cores **201** and **401** have surface zones of higher dopant concentration [D], surface zone **402** interfaces with surface zone **203**, forming a composite center zone within regions of core stack **501**. The composite of zones **203** and **402** is indicative of methods where two cores are joined. For some embodiments, a dopant zone of lesser thickness T3 is at the bottom of openings **310** while a dopant zone of greater thickness T4 is within regions beyond openings **310**. For embodiments where substrate core **201** includes both surface zones **202** and **203**, thickness T4 may be significantly greater than thickness T5 of surface zone **202**. In some embodiments, for example, thickness T4 is approximately twice the thickness T5.

[0065] For embodiments where substrate cores **201** and **401** both lack any surface zones of distinct composition, precise control of thickness T1 over the plurality of openings **310**, as well as low surface roughness of core surface **408**, indicates core stack **501** comprises a plurality of substrate cores.

[0066] Returning to FIG. **1**, methods **101** continue at block **140** where one or more IC die are placed within a recess or cavity of a substrate core stack. Each IC die may be positioned adjacent to sidewalls of a first substrate core and adhered to a surface of an underlying substrate core. Any adhesive or bond film known to be suitable for die attach (e.g., a thermoset) may be employed to hold the IC die upon a surface of a substrate core. In some examples, at block **140** a pick-and-place machine positions IC dies on patches of adhesive present at the bottom of a cavity. The adhesive may then be activated and/or cured (e.g., from a b-staged material).

[0067] FIG. **6A** illustrates a plan view of IC die **620** placed within openings **310** of workpiece **500**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. **6B** illustrates a cross-sectional view of workpiece **500** along the B-B' line shown in FIG. **6A**, in accordance with some embodiments. As illustrated, an adhesive **602** may be between core surface **408** and a surface of IC die **620**. Although adhesive **602** may have any composition suitable for die attach, in some examples adhesive **602** comprises a die-attach film (DAF), an epoxy, or a solder. In other embodiments, adhesive **602** may be absent with IC die **620** instead directly bonded to core surface **408**. A sidewall edge of IC die **620** is laterally adjacent to a sidewall edge of substrate core **201**. The size of a gap between an edge sidewall of IC die **620** and a nearest sidewall of substrate core **201** may vary, for example according to the precision of IC die placement.

[0068] Although FIG. **6A-6B** illustrate a single IC die embedded within each opening **310**, any number of IC die may be similarly placed laterally adjacent to each other over different regions of the underlying core surface **408** exposed within one opening **310**. In the example illustrated, IC die **620** has IC layers comprising a front side surface further comprising a metallization features **606**. In some examples, IC layers comprise active and/or passive devices electrically coupled to metallization features **606**. IC die **620** may be affixed to core substrate **401** “front-side up,” as shown, so that front-side metallization features **606** are distal from substrate core **401**. In alternative embodiments, IC die **620** may be flip-chip assembled “front-side down” so that front-side

metallization features **606** are instead proximal to substrate core **401**.

[0069] As shown in FIG. **6B**, IC die **620** (along with adhesive **602**) has thickness **T1** so that a front side surface of IC die **620** is substantially coplanar with the surrounding core surface **208** when back side die surface of IC die **620** is in contact with adhesive material **602**. As used herein, “substantially coplanar” means IC die **620** and substrate core **201** surfaces are within 10 μm of being coplanar.

[0070] IC die **620** may be a fully functional ASIC or may be a chiplet or tile that has more limited functionality supplementing one or more other IC dies that are to be part of the same multi-chip device. A chiplet or tile may, for example, include only passive devices, such as one or more capacitors, inductors, or resistors. FIG. **7** illustrates an expanded cross-sectional view of IC die **620**, in accordance with some embodiments where IC die includes trench capacitors **715**. As shown, trench capacitors **715** are embedded within a die substrate material **700** such as, but not limited to, a predominantly silicon (e.g., substantially pure Si) material, a predominantly germanium (e.g., substantially pure Ge) material, or a compound material, for example comprising Group IV majority constituents (e.g., SiGe alloys, GeSn alloys). Within trenches formed in die substrate material **700**, capacitor electrodes **704A** and **704B** separated by an intervening insulator **705**. Individual ones of electrodes **704A**, **704B** are coupled to individual ones of metallization features **606A**, **606B**, respectively. Trench capacitors **715** may have any architecture known for an IC die and may therefore provide a capacitive array of very high density that is, in some embodiments, suitable for implementing a power supply voltage regulator.

[0071] In alternative passive embodiments, IC die **620** is an electrical interconnect bridge IC die. The bridge die may include primarily interconnect metallization, for example that has been fabricated with a back-end-of-line (BEOL) monolithic IC die manufacturing process. Such a passive IC die may merely include interconnect routing to convey electrical communication signals between different metallization features **606**.

[0072] IC die **620** may also be “active” with one or more types of active devices within a die device layer that may include any semiconductor material. In some embodiments, the active devices are field effect transistors (FETs) with a device pitch of 80 nm, or less. The FETs may be of any architecture (e.g., planar, non-planar, single-gate, multi-gate, stacked nanosheet, etc.). In some embodiments, FET terminals have a feature pitch of 5-30 nm. Additionally, or in the alternative, IC die **620** may include active devices other than FETs. For example, a die device layer may include electronic memory structures, spin valves, etc.

[0073] IC die **620** may comprise one or more IC die metallization levels on either side of a die substrate material. In exemplary embodiments, die metallization features **606** (i.e., **606A**, **606B** in FIG. **7**) are embedded within an insulator. While IC die metallization features **606** may have any composition(s) of sufficient electrical conductivity, in exemplary embodiments, IC die metallization features **606** are predominantly copper (Cu). In other examples, metallization features **606** are predominantly other than Cu, such as, but not limited to predominantly Ru, or predominantly W. An uppermost one of metallization features **606** may have a feature pitch ranging from **100** nm to several microns, for example. IC die **621** illustrates another example where one or more through die substrate vias **630** intersect backside IC die metallization pads **631**. Metallization pads **631** may be bonded to corresponding metallization pads **633** on core substrate **401** through a solder feature **632**. Alternatively, and as illustrated for IC die **622** that illustrates a flip-chip orientation, metallization features **606** may be directly (hybrid) bonded to core **401** and metallization pads **633** embedded therein. Die TSVs **630** may have any architecture and generally include a metallization, such as, but not limited to, Cu. Notably, the IC die bonding variations illustrated in FIG. **6A** and **6B** need not be present within a single workpiece.

[0074] Returning to FIG. **1**, methods **101** continue at block **150** where a material is formed over and/or around the IC die embedded within the workpiece. In some embodiments, a mold material is molded around the embedded IC die, at least partially backfilling any gap between a sidewall of the

IC die and an adjacent sidewall of a substrate core. Alternatively, a wet dielectric material may be spin planarized over the workpiece and cured. Following molding or spin-on processing, the workpiece may be globally planarized, for example with any suitable chemical-mechanical polisher. Methods **101** then end with completion of a package assembly at output **160**, for example where any known package build-up process(es) may be performed.

[0075] FIG. **8A** and **8B** illustrate plan and sectional views of a planarized workpiece **500** comprising IC die embedded within a core stack, in accordance with some embodiments. In these examples, a mold material **808** forms a frame around IC die **620** and backfills any remaining open space within openings **310**. Gap width around IC die **620** may vary, for example from **100** nm to several microns. The composition of mold material **808** may vary with implementation. In some embodiments, mold material **808** is an organic material, such as an epoxy resin, phenolic-glass, or a resinous film. The epoxy resin may be, for example, an acrylate of novolac such as epoxy phenol novolacs (EPN) or epoxy cresol novolac (ECN)).

[0076] As illustrated in FIG. **8B**, workpiece **500** is ready to be further processed, for example according to a semi-additive packaging build-up process. FIG. **9** illustrates a flow diagram of methods **901** for forming an IC die package including an IC die embedded within a stacked core, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0077] Methods **901** begin at input **910** where a core stack including an embedded IC die structure is received. In some embodiments, workpiece **500** is received at input **910**. Alternatively, any another workpiece having an IC die similarly embedded within a stacked core may be received at input **910**.

[0078] At block **960**, conductive through vias may be formed through a total thickness of the core stack. Block **960** is illustrated in dashed line to emphasize formation of through vias is optional, for example because through vias may instead have been separately fabricated within individual substrate core preforms, which are then joined together into a core stack.

[0079] FIG. **10A** and FIG. **10B** are plan and sectional views depicting the formation of through vias **1010** in workpiece **500**. For the sake of clarity, workpiece **500** is illustrated to include a plurality of IC die **620**. Through vias may convey power into an embedded IC die comprising trench capacitors, for example. In the example illustrated, through vias **1010** have a continuous longitudinal via axis **1011** over the total thickness of core stack **501**. Continuous longitudinal via axis **1011** is indicative of through vias **1010** having been formed after formation of core stack **501**. In alternative embodiments, through vias are separately formed in each core preform prior to forming core stack **501**. For such embodiments, non-zero misalignment during the joining of substrate cores will induce some through via misalignment along the thickness of core stack **501**. Longitudinal via axis **1011** will then not be continuous as illustrated in FIG. **10B**, but instead will have some lateral offset, shift, or discontinuity at interface **510**. Although the longitudinal via axis may have discontinuity, such bonded or fused vias may nevertheless provide electrical continuity through core stack **501**.

[0080] For a core stack including through vias, methods **901** (FIG. **9**) continue at block **970** where electrical routing structures are formed over one or more of a front side and back side of the core stack to complete a package substrate. Any package routing process may be practiced at block **970**, such as any semi-additive process whereby metallization is deposited and dielectric material layers are built up by depositions or laminations, for example.

[0081] FIG. **11A** is a plan view illustrating interconnect levels formed on at least one side of workpiece **500**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. **11B** is a cross-sectional view of workpiece **500**, in accordance with some embodiments where interconnect levels are built-up on two opposite sides of a core stack.

[0082] In some embodiments, package dielectric material **1105** is an organic material, such as, an epoxy resin, phenolic-glass, or a resinous film such as the GX-series films commercially available from Ajinomoto Fine-Techno Co., Inc. (ABF). Package dielectric material **1105** may comprise

epoxy resins (e.g., EPN or ECN). In some specific examples, package dielectric **1105** is a bisphenol-A epoxy resin, for example including epichlorohydrin. In other examples, package dielectric material **1105** includes bisphenol-F epoxy resin (with epichlorohydrin). In other examples, package dielectric material **1105** includes aliphatic epoxy resin, which may be monofunctional (e.g., dodecanol glycidyl ether), difunctional (butanediol diglycidyl ether), or have higher functionality (e.g., trimethylolpropane triglycidyl ether). In still other examples, package dielectric material **1105** includes glycidylamine epoxy resin, such as triglycidyl-p-aminophenol (functionality 3) and N,N,N',N'-tetraglycidyl-bis-(4-aminophenyl)-methane (functionality 4).

[0083] The interconnect levels include RDL or routing metallization features **1106** embedded within package dielectric **1105**. The metallization features **1106** may comprise lateral runs fanning out I/O or power to and/or from IC dies **620** and terminating at interconnect interfaces on opposite sides of workpiece **500**. The number of layers and/or thicknesses of metallization features **1106** may vary according to implementation and requirements of the IC dies assembled with a particular device package. In some embodiments, each layer of metallization features **1106** is formed by first depositing a seed layer (e.g., Cu) and then forming a plating resist mask (not depicted) over the seed layer. With an electrolytic deposition process, Cu is plated upon the seed layer wherever the resist mask is absent. The building up of levels of metallization features **1106** may comprise any number of cycles with each cycle including application of an intervening layer of package dielectric material, patterning of the package dielectric material, and plating of conductive features within features patterned in the package dielectric material.

[0084] In accordance with some embodiments, interconnect features may be formed on exposed surfaces of conductive features of the package structures in preparation for assembly. A workpiece may then be singulated or disaggregated into multiple package substrates **1110**, **1115** and **1120**, each comprising package substrate edges **1101** that typically define rectangular prisms but may also define more complicated solid forms.

[0085] Returning to FIG. **9**, methods **901** continue at block **980** where one or more IC die structures are interconnected to routing structure interface features of a package substrate. IC die assembly at block **980** may be according to any known techniques. In some examples, IC die are directly bonded to a package substrate. In other embodiments, IC die are assembled to a package substrate with solder interconnect features. IC die assembly at block **980** may be performed before or after package substrate singulation.

[0086] IC dies assembled at block **980** may receive power at least partially conditioned or supplied through one or more IC die embedded within the package substrate, for example according to any of the embodiments described elsewhere herein. IC dies assembled at block **980** may also be at least partially interconnected to each other through one or more IC die embedded within the package substrate, for example according to any of the embodiments described elsewhere herein. Methods **901** end at output **990** where the device package assembly is further assembled, for example to any suitable host component.

[0087] FIG. **12A** illustrates a cross-sectional view of package substrate **1110** including IC die **620** embedded within a fused glass core stack, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown, package metallization **1106** couples IC die **620** to a package backside **1212**. In exemplary embodiments where IC die **620** comprises capacitors, power may be coupled from any host component into IC die **620** through backside **1212**.

[0088] FIG. **13** illustrates a cross-sectional view of a multi-chip package **1301** comprising IC die **1361** and **1362**, which are electrically coupled to package substrate **1110**, in accordance with some embodiments. IC die **1361** includes through die vias **1365** and is coupled to package substrate **1110** and/or IC die **620** in a back-to-front orientation. IC die **1362** illustrates an alternative front-to-front orientation with package substrate **1110** and/or IC die **620**.

[0089] IC die **1361** and **1362** may each be any fully functional ASIC, disaggregated tile, or chiplet of lesser functionality. At least one of IC die **1361**, **1362** may be any of a wireless radio circuit,

microprocessor core, electronic memory circuit, floating point gate array (FPGA), power management and/or power supply circuit, or include a MEMS device. In some examples, one or more of IC die **1361**, **1362** include one or more banks of active repeater circuitry to improve multi-chip interconnects (e.g., network-on-chip architectures). In other examples, one or more of IC die **1361**, **1362** include clock generator circuitry or temperature sensing circuitry. In other examples, one or more of IC die **1361**, **1362** include logic circuitry that implement mesh network-on-chip architectures. In still other examples, at least one of IC die **1361**, **1362** includes microprocessor core circuitry, for example comprising one or more shift registers. Such microprocessor core circuitry may be part of an intelligence processing unit (IPU), graphical process unit (GPU) or central processing unit, for example. In another embodiment, at least one of IC die **1361**, **1362** is a photonic IC (PIC), for example comprising one or more optical waveguides, optical multiplexer/demultiplexer, lasers and/or photodetectors.

[0090] In package **1301**, IC die **1361**, **1362** are interconnected to package substrate **1110** through solder interconnects **1393**. In other embodiments, IC die **1361**, **1362** are directly bonded (e.g., hybrid bonded) to a surface of package substrate **1110**. As shown, IC die **1361**, **1362** are interconnected to front side package metallization **1106**, which includes metallization features further coupled to IC die **620**. In some embodiments where IC die **620** comprises embedded capacitors, IC die **620** is coupled to a host power supply **1305**. IC die **1361** and **1362** are further coupled to receive power from IC die **620**, for example at a voltage stepped down from an output voltage of host power supply **1305**. IC die **1361**, **1362** include one or more I/O metallization routes further coupled to package backside **1212**, which may interface to any host component (e.g., with solder interconnects).

[0091] As shown in FIG. **13**, IC die **1361** and **1362** are embedded in a package dielectric **1394**, which may be any mold material, for example. One or more heat spreaders and/or heat sinks (not depicted) may be further coupled to exposed surfaces of IC die **1361**, **1362**.

[0092] FIG. **14** illustrates a computing platform **1405**. Computing platform **1405** may be any commercial server, for example including any number of high-performance computing platforms within a rack and networked together for electronic data processing, which in the exemplary embodiment includes a multi-chip package **1301**, for example as described elsewhere herein. Computing platform **1405** may include an integrated or disintegrated IC die system **1410**, and a battery **1415**.

[0093] As illustrated in the expanded view, IC die system **1410** comprises one or more of a power management integrated circuit (PMIC) **1430** or RF (wireless) integrated circuit (RFIC) **1425** including a wideband RF (wireless) transmitter and/or receiver. IC die system **1410** further includes one or more of a memory and/or processor core **1450** assembled to a package substrate **1110**. PMIC **1430** may perform battery power regulation, DC-to-DC conversion, etc., and so has an input coupled to battery **1415** and with an output providing a current supply to other functional modules. In some embodiments PMIC **1430** receives power from an embedded IC die comprising capacitors, for example embedded in a core of package substrate **1110** as described elsewhere herein. As further illustrated, in the exemplary embodiment, an RFIC **1425** has an output coupled to an antenna (not shown) to implement any of a number of wireless standards or protocols, including but not limited to Wi-Fi (IEEE 802.11 family), WiMAX (IEEE 802.16 family), IEEE 802.20, long term evolution (LTE), Ev-DO, HSPA+, HSDPA+, HSUPA+, EDGE, GSM, GPRS, CDMA, TDMA, DECT, Bluetooth, derivatives thereof, as well as any other wireless protocols that are designated as 3G, 4G, and beyond.

[0094] FIG. **15** is a block diagram of a cryogenically cooled computing device **1500** in accordance with some embodiments. For example, one or more components of computing device **1500** may include any of the devices or structures discussed elsewhere herein. Several components are illustrated in FIG. **15**, but any one or more of these components may be omitted or duplicated, as suitable for the application. In some embodiments, some or all the components included in

computing device **1500** may be attached to one or more printed circuit boards (e.g., a motherboard). In some embodiments, various ones of these components may be fabricated onto a single system-on-a-chip (SoC) die. Additionally, in various embodiments, computing device **1500** may not include one or more of the components illustrated in FIG. **15**, but computing device **1500** may include interface circuitry for coupling to the one or more components. For example, computing device **1500** may not include a display device **1503**, but may include display device interface circuitry (e.g., a connector and driver circuitry) to which display device **1503** may be coupled.

[0095] Computing device **1500** may include a processing device **1501** (e.g., one or more processing devices). As used herein, the term processing device or processor indicates a device that processes electronic data from registers and/or memory to transform that electronic data into other electronic data that may be stored in registers and/or memory. Processing device **1501** may include a memory **1521**, a communication device **1522**, a refrigeration/active cooling device **1523**, a battery/power regulation device **1524**, logic **1525**, interconnects **1526**, a heat regulation device **1527**, and a hardware security device **1528**.

[0096] Processing device **1501** may include one or more digital signal processors (DSPs), application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), central processing units (CPUs), graphics processing units (GPUs), cryptoprocessors (specialized processors that execute cryptographic algorithms within hardware), server processors, or any other suitable processing devices.

[0097] Processing device **1501** may include a memory **1502**, which may itself include one or more memory devices such as volatile memory (e.g., dynamic random-access memory (DRAM)), nonvolatile memory (e.g., read-only memory (ROM)), flash memory, solid state memory, and/or a hard drive. In some embodiments, memory **1521** includes memory that shares a die with processing device **1501**. This memory may be used as cache memory and may include embedded dynamic random-access memory (eDRAM) or spin transfer torque magnetic random-access memory (STT-MRAM).

[0098] Computing device **1500** may include a heat regulation/refrigeration device **1523**. Heat regulation/refrigeration device **1523** may maintain processing device **1501** (and/or other components of computing device **1500**) at a predetermined low temperature during operation. This predetermined low temperature may be any temperature discussed elsewhere herein.

[0099] In some embodiments, computing device **1500** may include a communication chip **1507** (e.g., one or more communication chips). For example, the communication chip **1507** may be configured for managing wireless communications for the transfer of data to and from computing device **1500**. The term “wireless” and its derivatives may be used to describe circuits, devices, systems, methods, techniques, communications channels, etc., that may communicate data through the use of modulated electromagnetic radiation through a nonsolid medium.

[0100] Communication chip **1507** may implement any wireless standards or protocols, including but not limited to Institute for Electrical and Electronic Engineers (IEEE) standards including Wi-Fi (IEEE 802.11 family), IEEE 802.16 standards (e.g., IEEE 802.16-2005 Amendment), Long-Term Evolution (LTE) project along with any amendments, updates, and/or revisions (e.g., advanced LTE project, ultramobile broadband (UMB) project (also referred to as “3GPP2”), etc.). IEEE 802.16 compatible Broadband Wireless Access (BWA) networks are generally referred to as WiMAX networks, an acronym that stands for Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access, which is a certification mark for products that pass conformity and interoperability tests for the IEEE 802.16 standards. Communication chip **1507** may operate in accordance with a Global System for Mobile Communication (GSM), General Packet Radio Service (GPRS), Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS), High Speed Packet Access (HSPA), Evolved HSPA (E-HSPA), or LTE network. Communication chip **1507** may operate in accordance with Enhanced Data for GSM Evolution (EDGE), GSM EDGE Radio Access Network (GERAN), Universal Terrestrial Radio Access Network (UTRAN), or Evolved UTRAN (E-UTRAN). Communication

chip **1507** may operate in accordance with Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA), Time Division Multiple Access (TDMA), Digital Enhanced Cordless Telecommunications (DECT), Evolution-Data Optimized (EV-DO), and derivatives thereof, as well as any other wireless protocols that are designated as 3G, 4G, 5G, and beyond. Communication chip **1507** may operate in accordance with other wireless protocols in other embodiments. Computing device **1500** may include an antenna **1513** to facilitate wireless communications and/or to receive other wireless communications (such as AM or FM radio transmissions).

[0101] In some embodiments, communication chip **1507** may manage wired communications, such as electrical, optical, or any other suitable communication protocols (e.g., the Ethernet). As noted above, communication chip **1507** may include multiple communication chips. For instance, a first communication chip **1507** may be dedicated to shorter-range wireless communications such as Wi-Fi or Bluetooth, and a second communication chip **1507** may be dedicated to longer-range wireless communications such as GPS, EDGE, GPRS, CDMA, WiMAX, LTE, EV-DO, or others. In some embodiments, a first communication chip **1507** may be dedicated to wireless communications, and a second communication chip **1507** may be dedicated to wired communications.

[0102] Computing device **1500** may include battery/power circuitry **1508**. Battery/power circuitry **1508** may include one or more energy storage devices (e.g., batteries or capacitors) and/or circuitry for coupling components of computing device **1500** to an energy source separate from computing device **1500** (e.g., AC line power).

[0103] Computing device **1500** may include a display device **1503** (or corresponding interface circuitry, as discussed above). Display device **1503** may include any visual indicators, such as a heads-up display, a computer monitor, a projector, a touchscreen display, a liquid crystal display (LCD), a light-emitting diode display, or a flat panel display, for example.

[0104] Computing device **1500** may include an audio output device **1504** (or corresponding interface circuitry, as discussed above). Audio output device **1504** may include any device that generates an audible indicator, such as speakers, headsets, or earbuds, for example.

[0105] Computing device **1500** may include an audio input device **1510** (or corresponding interface circuitry, as discussed above). Audio input device **1510** may include any device that generates a signal representative of a sound, such as microphones, microphone arrays, or digital instruments (e.g., instruments having a musical instrument digital interface (MIDI) output).

[0106] Computing device **1500** may include a global positioning system (GPS) device **1509** (or corresponding interface circuitry, as discussed above). GPS device **1509** may be in communication with a satellite-based system and may receive a location of computing device **1500**, as known in the art.

[0107] Computing device **1500** may include another output device **1505** (or corresponding interface circuitry, as discussed above). Examples include an audio codec, a video codec, a printer, a wired or wireless transmitter for providing information to other devices, or an additional storage device.

[0108] Computing device **1500** may include another input device **1511** (or corresponding interface circuitry, as discussed above). Examples may include an accelerometer, a gyroscope, a compass, an image capture device, a keyboard, a cursor control device such as a mouse, a stylus, a touchpad, a bar code reader, a Quick Response (QR) code reader, any sensor, or a radio frequency identification (RFID) reader.

[0109] Computing device **1500** may include a security interface device **1512**. Security interface device **1512** may include any device that provides security measures for computing device **1500** such as intrusion detection, biometric validation, security encode or decode, managing access lists, malware detection, or spyware detection.

[0110] Computing device **1500**, or a subset of its components, may have any appropriate form factor, such as a hand-held or mobile computing device (e.g., a cell phone, a smart phone, a mobile internet device, a music player, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a netbook computer, an

ultrabook computer, a personal digital assistant (PDA), an ultramobile personal computer, etc.), a desktop computing device, a server or other networked computing component, a printer, a scanner, a monitor, a set-top box, an entertainment control unit, a vehicle control unit, a digital camera, a digital video recorder, or a wearable computing device.

[0111] While certain features set forth herein have been described with reference to various implementations, this description is not intended to be construed in a limiting sense. Hence, various modifications of the implementations described herein, as well as other implementations, which are apparent to persons skilled in the art to which the present disclosure pertains are deemed to lie within the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

[0112] It will be recognized that practice of the disclosed techniques and architectures is not limited to the embodiments so described but can be modified and altered without departing from the scope of the appended claims. For example, the above embodiments may include specific combinations of features as further provided below.

[0113] In first examples, an apparatus comprises a first substrate core and a second substrate core in a stack with the first substrate core, a surface of the second substrate core is exposed within an opening in the first substrate core. The apparatus comprises an IC die within the opening in the first substrate core and one or more levels of metallization are over the first substrate core and coupled with the IC die.

[0114] In second examples, for any of the first examples the surface of the second substrate core exposed within the opening has an RMS roughness of no more than 50 nm.

[0115] In third examples, for any of the first through second examples a surface of the first substrate core is within **10** μm of being coplanar with a surface of the IC die.

[0116] In fourth examples, for any of the first through third examples the first substrate core is in direct contact with the second substrate core, and a core interface between the first substrate core and the second substrate core is substantially coplanar with the surface of the second substrate core exposed within the opening in first substrate core.

[0117] In fifth examples, for any of the fourth examples the first substrate core comprises a first layer of glass, the second substrate core comprises a second layer of glass, and the first layer of glass is fused along the core interface to the second layer of glass.

[0118] In sixth examples, for any of the fourth through fifth examples the first substrate core is a first piece of bulk glass having a thickness of at least 50 μm , the second substrate core is a second piece of bulk glass having a thickness of at least 50 μm , and the first piece of bulk glass is fused along the core interface to the second piece of bulk glass.

[0119] In seventh examples, for any of the fifth or sixth examples a concentration of a dopant within the first substrate core is higher proximal to the core interface than at a half thickness of the first substrate, or a concentration of a dopant within the second substrate core is higher proximal to the core interface than at a half thickness of the second substrate.

[0120] In eighth examples, for any of the seventh examples the concentration of the dopant within the second substrate core is higher proximal to the IC die than at the half thickness of the second substrate core.

[0121] In ninth examples, for any of the seventh through eighth examples the dopant comprises K, Na, or Ag.

[0122] In tenth examples, for any of the first through ninth examples the apparatus comprises a conductive via extending through both the first substrate core and the second substrate core.

[0123] In eleventh examples, for any of the tenth examples a longitudinal axis of the conductive via is continuous through the first substrate core and through the second substrate core.

[0124] In twelfth examples, for any of the first through eleventh examples the IC die is a first IC die and wherein the apparatus further comprises one or more second IC die coupled to the metallization.

[0125] In thirteenth examples, for any of the twelfth examples the first IC die comprises a plurality

of trench capacitors and wherein the second IC die are coupled to receive power through a voltage regulator comprising the trench capacitors.

[0126] In fourteenth examples, an apparatus comprises a first IC die and a package substrate coupled to the first IC die. The package substrate comprises one or more levels of metallization between the first IC die and a second IC die embedded within the package substrate, and a glass core comprising a first thickness of glass surrounding the second IC die and a second thickness of glass fused to the first thickness of glass and under the second IC die.

[0127] In fifteenth examples, for any of the fourteenth examples a surface of the second IC die closest to the first IC die is substantially coplanar with a surface of the glass core closest to the first IC die.

[0128] In sixteenth examples, for any of the fourteenth through sixteenth examples the metallization comprises first features coupling the second IC die to a host power supply and the metallization comprises second features coupling the second IC die to the first IC die.

[0129] In seventeenth examples, for any of the fourteenth through sixteenth examples the apparatus comprises a third IC die adjacent to the first IC die, wherein the metallization comprises features coupling the second IC die to both the first IC die and the second IC die.

[0130] In eighteenth examples, a method comprises joining a first substrate core and a second substrate core, the first substrate core having an opening therein, which exposes a surface of the second substrate core. The method comprises placing an IC die within the opening. The method comprises forming one or more levels of metallization over the first substrate core and over the IC die.

[0131] In nineteenth examples, for any of the eighteenth examples the method comprises etching the opening completely through the first substrate core prior to joining the first substrate core with second substrate core.

[0132] In twentieth examples for any of the eighteenth through nineteenth examples the first substrate core is a first piece of glass, the second substrate core is a second piece of glass, and the joining comprises fusing a surface of the first piece of glass to a surface of the second piece of glass.

[0133] However, the above embodiments are not limited in this regard, and, in various implementations, the above embodiments may include the undertaking of only a subset of such features, undertaking a different order of such features, undertaking a different combination of such features, and/or undertaking additional features than those features explicitly listed. The scope of the disclosed techniques and architectures should therefore be determined with reference to the appended claims, along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled.

Claims

1. An apparatus, comprising: a first substrate core; a second substrate core in a stack with the first substrate core, a surface of the second substrate core exposed within an opening in the first substrate core; an IC die within the opening in the first substrate core; and one or more levels of metallization over the first substrate core and coupled with the IC die.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the surface of the second substrate core exposed within the opening has an RMS roughness of no more than 50 nm.
3. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein: a surface of the first substrate core is within 10 μm of being coplanar with a surface of the IC die.
4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first substrate core is in direct contact with the second substrate core, and a core interface between the first substrate core and the second substrate core is substantially coplanar with the surface of the second substrate core exposed within the opening in first substrate core.
5. The apparatus of claim 4, wherein: the first substrate core comprises a first layer of glass; the

second substrate core comprises a second layer of glass; and the first layer of glass is fused along the core interface to the second layer of glass.

6. The apparatus of claim 4, wherein: the first substrate core is a first piece of bulk glass having a thickness of at least 50 μm ; the second substrate core is a second piece of bulk glass having a thickness of at least 50 μm ; and the first piece of bulk glass is fused along the core interface to the second piece of bulk glass.

7. The apparatus of claim 5, wherein: a concentration of a dopant within the first substrate core is higher proximal to the core interface than at a half thickness of the first substrate, or a concentration of a dopant within the second substrate core is higher proximal to the core interface than at a half thickness of the second substrate.

8. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the concentration of the dopant within the second substrate core is higher proximal to the IC die than at the half thickness of the second substrate core.

9. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the dopant comprises K, Na, or Ag.

10. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising a conductive via extending through both the first substrate core and the second substrate core.

11. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein a longitudinal axis of the conductive via is continuous through the first substrate core and through the second substrate core.

12. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the IC die is a first IC die and wherein the apparatus further comprises one or more second IC die coupled to the metallization.

13. The apparatus of claim 12, wherein the first IC die comprises a plurality of trench capacitors and wherein the second IC die is coupled to receive power through a voltage regulator comprising the trench capacitors.

14. An apparatus comprising: a first IC die; and a package substrate coupled to the first IC die, wherein the package substrate comprises: one or more levels of metallization between the first IC die and a second IC die embedded within the package substrate; and a glass core comprising a first thickness of glass surrounding the second IC die and a second thickness of glass fused to the first thickness of glass and under the second IC die.

15. The apparatus of claim 14, wherein a surface of the second IC die closest to the first IC die is substantially coplanar with a surface of the glass core closest to the first IC die.

16. The apparatus of claim 14, wherein the metallization comprises first features coupling the second IC die to a host power supply and wherein the metallization comprises second features coupling the second IC die to the first IC die.

17. The apparatus of claim 14, further comprising a third IC die adjacent to the first IC die, wherein the metallization comprises features coupling the third IC die to both the first IC die and the second IC die.

18. A method comprising: joining a first substrate core and a second substrate core, the first substrate core having an opening therein, which exposes a surface of the second substrate core; placing an IC die within the opening; and forming one or more levels of metallization over the first substrate core and over the IC die.

19. The method of claim 18, further comprising etching the opening completely through the first substrate core prior to joining the first substrate core with second substrate core.

20. The method of claim 18, wherein: the first substrate core is a first piece of glass; the second substrate core is a second piece of glass; and the joining comprises fusing a surface of the first piece of glass to a surface of the second piece of glass.
